

# Chapter 4 — The Age of Industrialisation

**The one-line point:** This chapter exists to **dismantle a story you already believe** — that industrialisation means factories, machines and steady technological triumph. NCERT's answer: **large-scale production for a world market existed BEFORE factories; the typical nineteenth-century worker was NOT a machine operator; British industrialists often PREFERRED hand labour; and in India, handloom cloth production actually TREBLED between 1900 and 1940.** The age of factories was also, everywhere, an age of hands.

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## Syllabus Classification

| Field                | Value                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Subject              | History → <b>World History</b> + <b>Economic history of colonial India</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Sub-discipline       | <b>Industrial and labour history</b> · de-industrialisation · history of technology                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Period               | <b>c. 1600 – 1940s</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Prelims (GS Paper I) | ★ ★ ★ Proto-industrialisation, guilds, Arkwright, the Spinning Jenny, the steam engine figures, gomastha, the Surat/Bombay shift, fly shuttle, the first mills — all clean factual items                                                                                                                                                   |
| Mains (GS Paper I)   | ★ ★ ★ ★ <b>"industrial revolution"</b> is a syllabus word; and <b>the de-industrialisation of India is a standard question</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Also feeds           | ★ ★ ★ ★ <b>GS3 Economy (MSMEs and the informal sector)</b> — this chapter is the historical case for why small-scale production is not a leftover; also import substitution, tariff protection), <b>GS1 Society</b> ★ ★ ★ (labour migration, the jobber, women's work), <b>Essay</b> ★ ★ ★ ★ (technology and progress; who writes history) |
| Weightage            | ★ ★ ★ ★                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Overlaps with        | ★ ★ ★ ★ <b>Ch.3 of this book</b> (the export figures and tariffs — <b>read the two together</b> ), <b>Class 9 supplement</b> (enclosures and the commons that pushed peasants into proto-industry; Captain Swing), <b>Ch.2 of this book</b> (Swadeshi, tariff protection, the business classes)                                            |

## Learning Outcomes

By the end of this chapter you should be able to:

- ☐ ★ ★ ★ ★ **Define proto-industrialisation** and explain why merchants went to the countryside.
- ☐ **Explain what guilds were** and why they blocked urban expansion. ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Describe the proto-industrial chain** from wool stapler to London. ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Explain what the factory changed** — Arkwright and the cotton mill. ★ ★ ★
- ☐ ★ ★ ★ ★ **Give the FOUR points on the pace of industrial change**, with figures.
- ☐ ★ ★ ★ ★ **Explain why British industrialists preferred hand labour** — four reasons.
- ☐ **Describe the life of workers** — seasonality, networks, the meaning of wages. ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Explain why women attacked the Spinning Jenny.** ★ ★ ★
- ☐ **Describe India's pre-colonial textile network** and why it broke down. ★ ★ ★ ★
- ☐ ★ ★ ★ ★ **Explain the gomastha system** and how it destroyed the weaver's bargaining power.

- ☐ ★★★★★ Explain the **THREE successive blows** to Indian weavers.
- ☐ Name the **early Indian entrepreneurs** and where their capital came from. ★★★
- ☐ Explain the **jobber's role and power**. ★★★
- ☐ Explain why Indian mills first made **YARN, not cloth**. ★★★★★
- ☐ ★★★★★ Explain why handloom production **trebled between 1900 and 1940**.
- ☐ Explain how **advertisements created consumers**, and the nationalist counter-use. ★★★

## Start Here: Two Pictures and a Warning

**\*\*Picture 1 — E.T. Paull's "Dawn of the Century", 1900.\*\*** At the centre is **"a goddess-like figure, the angel of progress, bearing the flag of the new century... perched on a wheel with wings, symbolising time.** Her flight is taking her into the future. **Floating about, behind her, are the signs of progress: RAILWAY, CAMERA, MACHINES, PRINTING PRESS and FACTORY."**

**\*\*Picture 2 — "Two Magicians", a trade magazine, 26 January 1901.\*\*** *"The one at the top is **ALADDIN from the ORIENT** who built a beautiful palace with **his magic lamp**. The one at the bottom is **the MODERN MECHANIC**, who with his **modern tools** weaves a new magic: **builds bridges, ships, towers and high-rise buildings**."* ★★ **"Aladdin is shown as representing the EAST and the PAST; the mechanic stands for the WEST and MODERNITY."**

**Word: ★ Orient — "the countries to the east of the Mediterranean, usually referring to Asia. The term arises out of A WESTERN VIEWPOINT that sees this region as PRE-MODERN, TRADITIONAL AND MYSTERIOUS."**

★★★★★ NCERT is showing you the propaganda before giving you the history, and the move is worth noticing. *"These images offer us a **TRIUMPHANT ACCOUNT** of the modern world... **The history of industrialisation thus becomes SIMPLY A STORY OF DEVELOPMENT**, and the modern age appears as **a wonderful time of technological progress**."* Then it turns the question on you: **"Do you not see rapid industrialisation as a time of progress and modernity?"** 🎯 **The whole chapter is an argument against the picture on its own first page.** And note the second image is not merely about machines — it is a **racial and civilisational claim**: East = magic and the past, West = tools and the future. **Technology was used to argue that some peoples belonged to history's future and others to its past** — the same claim that justified colonial rule. (*Compare Class 8 Ch.1's James Mill and Class 9 Ch.3's misuse of Darwin.*)

## **1** Before the Industrial Revolution — Proto-industrialisation ★★★

**The correction:** *"All too often we **associate industrialisation with the growth of FACTORY industry**... Histories of industrialisation very often begin with the setting up of the first factories. **THERE IS A PROBLEM WITH SUCH IDEAS. Even BEFORE factories began to dot the landscape in England and Europe, THERE WAS LARGE-SCALE INDUSTRIAL PRODUCTION FOR AN INTERNATIONAL MARKET. THIS WAS NOT BASED ON FACTORIES.** Many historians now refer to this phase as ★★ **PROTO-INDUSTRIALISATION**."*

**Word: ★ Proto — "indicating the FIRST or EARLY FORM of something."**

## Why the merchants went to the countryside

### THE PULL

"In the SEVENTEENTH AND EIGHTEENTH CENTURIES, merchants from the TOWNS in Europe began MOVING TO THE COUNTRYSIDE, supplying MONEY to peasants and artisans, PERSUADING THEM TO PRODUCE FOR AN INTERNATIONAL MARKET."

"With the EXPANSION OF WORLD TRADE and the ACQUISITION OF COLONIES, THE DEMAND FOR GOODS BEGAN GROWING."

### THE BLOCKAGE IN THE TOWNS -- THE GUILDS

"merchants COULD NOT EXPAND PRODUCTION WITHIN TOWNS. This was because here URBAN CRAFTS AND TRADE GUILDS WERE POWERFUL."

Guilds were "ASSOCIATIONS OF PRODUCERS that:

- TRAINED CRAFTSPEOPLE
- MAINTAINED CONTROL OVER PRODUCTION
- REGULATED COMPETITION AND PRICES
- RESTRICTED THE ENTRY OF NEW PEOPLE INTO THE TRADE"

"Rulers granted different guilds the MONOPOLY RIGHT to produce and trade in specific products. IT WAS THEREFORE DIFFICULT FOR NEW MERCHANTS TO SET UP BUSINESS IN TOWNS. SO THEY TURNED TO THE COUNTRYSIDE."

### AND WHY THE COUNTRYSIDE SAID YES

"this was a time when OPEN FIELDS WERE DISAPPEARING and COMMONS WERE BEING ENCLOSED. Cottagers and poor peasants who had earlier depended on common lands for their survival -- GATHERING THEIR FIREWOOD, BERRIES, VEGETABLES, HAY AND STRAW -- HAD TO NOW LOOK FOR ALTERNATIVE SOURCES OF INCOME."

"Many had TINY PLOTS OF LAND which could not provide work for all members of the household. So when merchants came around and OFFERED ADVANCES, peasant households EAGERLY AGREED."

### THREE THINGS IT GAVE THEM:

1. "they could REMAIN IN THE COUNTRYSIDE and CONTINUE TO CULTIVATE THEIR SMALL PLOTS"
2. "Income from proto-industrial production SUPPLEMENTED THEIR SHRINKING INCOME FROM CULTIVATION"
3. "It also allowed them A FULLER USE OF THEIR FAMILY LABOUR RESOURCES"

 ★★★★★ This is the Class 9 supplement joining directly onto Class 10. The enclosures that took the commons — firewood, berries, hay, straw — are what **created the rural labour force that proto-industry then employed. Enclosure did not merely impoverish the cottager; it manufactured the outworker.** Read *Peasants and Farmers* §1.4 and this passage together and the two books become one argument.

## The proto-industrial chain — ★★☆☆ learn the sequence

### A MERCHANT CLOTHIER IN ENGLAND

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buys WOOL from a WOOL STAPLER
|
v carries it to
SPINNERS -- who spin it into YARN (thread)
|
v taken in subsequent stages to
WEAVERS
|
v
FULLERS
|
v
DYERS
|
v
THE FINISHING was done in LONDON before the export
merchant sold the cloth in the international market.
"LONDON in fact came to be known as A FINISHING CENTRE."

THE SCALE: "At each stage of production 20 TO 25 WORKERS
were employed by each merchant. THIS MEANT THAT EACH
CLOTHIER WAS CONTROLLING HUNDREDS OF WORKERS."

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**Words:** ★ Stapler — a person who "staples" or SORTS WOOL according to its fibre. ★ Fuller — a person who "fulls", that is, GATHERS CLOTH BY PLEATING. ★ Carding — the process in which fibres, such as cotton or wool, are PREPARED PRIOR TO SPINNING.

★★★★ \*"This proto-industrial system was... a network of COMMERCIAL EXCHANGES. It was CONTROLLED BY MERCHANTS and the goods were PRODUCED BY A VAST NUMBER OF PRODUCERS WORKING WITHIN THEIR FAMILY FARMS, NOT IN FACTORIES."\*  Note where the control sits — with the merchant who owns the raw material and the market, not with the producer who owns the tools. A weaver with his own loom in his own cottage looks independent and is not. ★ This is exactly the relationship the gomastha will impose on Indian weavers in §3.2 — and exactly the relationship in the Silesian weavers' revolt (Ch.1 §3.2) and the Captain Swing letters. Learn the pattern once and it recognises itself everywhere.

## 1.1 The coming up of the factory

| Fact                                | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ★ The earliest factories            | "came up by the 1730s. But it was only in the late eighteenth century that the number of factories multiplied"                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| ★★ The first symbol                 | COTTON. "In 1760 Britain was importing 2.5 MILLION POUNDS of raw cotton... By 1787 this import soared to 22 MILLION POUNDS"                                                                                                                                                                     |
| The inventions                      | "A series of inventions in the eighteenth century increased the efficacy of each step (carding, twisting and spinning, and rolling). They enhanced the output per worker... and made possible stronger threads and yarn"                                                                        |
| ★★★ Arkwright's mill                | "Then RICHARD ARKWRIGHT created the COTTON MILL. Till this time cloth production was spread all over the countryside and carried out within village households. But now, the costly new machines could be PURCHASED, SET UP AND MAINTAINED IN THE MILL"                                         |
| ★★★★ What the mill actually changed | "Within the mill ALL THE PROCESSES WERE BROUGHT TOGETHER UNDER ONE ROOF AND MANAGEMENT. This allowed A MORE CAREFUL SUPERVISION over the production process, A WATCH OVER QUALITY, and THE REGULATION OF LABOUR — all of which had been DIFFICULT TO DO when production was in the countryside" |

🎯 ★★★★★ **Read that last row carefully — it is the most important idea in section 1.** The factory's advantage is listed as **supervision, quality control and the regulation of labour**, not as *machines or productivity*. ★ **The factory was a solution to a CONTROL problem before it was a solution to a technical one.** A merchant with workers scattered across a hundred cottages cannot check quality, cannot stop embezzlement of yarn, and cannot set the pace of work. **Under one roof, he can.** (*This is why Ford's conveyor belt in Ch.3 is the same idea perfected — the pace is dictated by the belt, not the worker.*)

⚠️ ★★★★★ **And the historian's warning NCERT adds:** *"So visible were the imposing new mills, so magical seemed to be the power of new technology, that contemporaries were DAZZLED. THEY CONCENTRATED THEIR ATTENTION ON THE MILLS, ALMOST FORGETTING THE BYLANES AND THE WORKSHOPS WHERE PRODUCTION STILL CONTINUED."* NCERT's own activity makes the methodological point: *"the way in which historians focus on industrialisation rather than on small workshops is a good example of how what we believe today about the past is influenced by WHAT HISTORIANS CHOOSE TO NOTICE AND WHAT THEY IGNORE."* ★ **Keep this — it is a first-rate line for any answer about historiography, and it applies equally to the informal sector in India today.**

## 📊 1.2 The pace of industrial change — ★★★★★ **FOUR points, all examinable**

FIRST -- WHICH INDUSTRIES ACTUALLY LED  
"The MOST DYNAMIC industries in Britain were clearly COTTON AND METALS."  
- COTTON led "in the FIRST PHASE of industrialisation UP TO THE 1840s"  
- "After that THE IRON AND STEEL INDUSTRY LED THE WAY"  
- with railways expanding "in ENGLAND FROM THE 1840s and in THE COLONIES FROM THE 1860s", demand for iron and steel rose rapidly  
"By 1873 Britain was EXPORTING IRON AND STEEL WORTH ABOUT £77 MILLION, DOUBLE THE VALUE OF ITS COTTON EXPORT"

SECOND -- NEW INDUSTRIES COULD NOT DISPLACE THE OLD  
"Even at the END OF THE NINETEENTH CENTURY, LESS THAN 20 PER CENT OF THE TOTAL WORKFORCE WAS EMPLOYED IN TECHNOLOGICALLY ADVANCED INDUSTRIAL SECTORS.  
Textiles was a dynamic sector. BUT A LARGE PORTION OF THE OUTPUT WAS PRODUCED NOT WITHIN FACTORIES, BUT OUTSIDE, WITHIN DOMESTIC UNITS."

THIRD -- THE 'TRADITIONAL' SECTORS WERE NOT STAGNANT  
"the pace of change in the 'traditional' industries was NOT SET BY steam-powered cotton or metal industries, BUT THEY DID NOT REMAIN ENTIRELY STAGNANT EITHER.  
SEEMINGLY ORDINARY AND SMALL INNOVATIONS WERE THE BASIS OF GROWTH in many NON-MECHANISED sectors: FOOD PROCESSING, BUILDING, POTTERY, GLASS WORK, TANNING, FURNITURE MAKING, and PRODUCTION OF IMPLEMENTS."

FOURTH -- TECHNOLOGY SPREAD SLOWLY  
"New technology was EXPENSIVE and merchants and industrialists were CAUTIOUS about using it. THE MACHINES OFTEN BROKE DOWN AND REPAIR WAS COSTLY. THEY WERE NOT AS EFFECTIVE AS THEIR INVENTORS AND MANUFACTURERS CLAIMED."

★★★★★ **The steam engine — the killer example:**

**\*"JAMES WATT improved the steam engine produced by NEWCOMEN and PATENTED the new engine in 1781. His industrialist friend MATHEW BOULTON manufactured the new model. BUT FOR YEARS HE COULD FIND NO BUYERS. At the beginning of the nineteenth century, there were no more than ★★ 321 STEAM ENGINES ALL OVER ENGLAND. Of these, 80 were in COTTON industries, NINE in WOOL industries, and the rest in MINING, CANAL WORKS and IRON WORKS. STEAM ENGINES WERE NOT USED IN ANY OF THE OTHER INDUSTRIES TILL MUCH LATER in the century. So even the most powerful new technology that enhanced the productivity of labour manifold WAS SLOW TO BE ACCEPTED BY INDUSTRIALISTS."\***

**★★★★ 321 steam engines in the whole of England is the single most useful number in this chapter. The device that gives the Industrial Revolution its name existed in a few hundred copies, in a handful of sectors, decades after its invention. ★ And NCERT's conclusion: \*"Historians now have come to increasingly recognise that THE TYPICAL WORKER IN THE MID-NINETEENTH CENTURY WAS NOT A MACHINE OPERATOR BUT THE TRADITIONAL CRAFTSPERSON AND LABOURER."\*** 🎯 Say this in any answer on the Industrial Revolution and you will separate yourself immediately from candidates writing about steam and steel.

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## **2 Hand Labour and Steam Power — ★★★★★ NCERT asks this directly**

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**The question: "Why did some industrialists in nineteenth-century Europe *prefer hand labour over machines?*" — NCERT gives four reasons. Give all four.**



REASON 1 -- LABOUR WAS ABUNDANT AND THEREFORE CHEAP  
"In Victorian Britain there was NO SHORTAGE of human labour. POOR PEASANTS AND VAGRANTS MOVED TO THE CITIES IN LARGE NUMBERS in search of jobs, waiting for work."

"When there is PLENTY OF LABOUR, WAGES ARE LOW. So industrialists had NO PROBLEM of labour shortage or high wage costs. THEY DID NOT WANT TO INTRODUCE MACHINES THAT GOT RID OF HUMAN LABOUR AND REQUIRED LARGE CAPITAL INVESTMENT."

REASON 2 -- SEASONAL DEMAND

"GAS WORKS and BREWERIES were especially busy through THE COLD MONTHS." "BOOK-BINDERS AND PRINTERS, catering to CHRISTMAS demand, needed extra hands before December." "At the WATERFRONT, WINTER was the time that SHIPS WERE REPAIRED and spruced up."

"In all such industries where PRODUCTION FLUCTUATED WITH THE SEASON, industrialists usually PREFERRED HAND LABOUR, EMPLOYING WORKERS FOR THE SEASON."

REASON 3 -- MACHINES MAKE UNIFORM GOODS; THE MARKET WANTED VARIETY

"Machines were oriented to producing UNIFORM, STANDARDISED goods for a MASS MARKET. But the demand in the market was often for goods with INTRICATE DESIGNS AND SPECIFIC SHAPES."

"In mid-nineteenth-century Britain, 500 VARIETIES OF HAMMERS were produced and 45 KINDS OF AXES. THESE REQUIRED HUMAN SKILL, NOT MECHANICAL TECHNOLOGY."

REASON 4 -- HANDMADE MEANT CLASS

"In Victorian Britain, THE UPPER CLASSES -- the aristocrats and the bourgeoisie -- PREFERRED THINGS PRODUCED BY HAND. Handmade products came to SYMBOLISE REFINEMENT AND CLASS. They were BETTER FINISHED, INDIVIDUALLY PRODUCED, and CAREFULLY DESIGNED."

"MACHINE-MADE GOODS WERE FOR EXPORT TO THE COLONIES."

THE CONTRAST: "In countries with LABOUR SHORTAGE, industrialists were KEEN ON USING MECHANICAL POWER so that the need for human labour can be minimised. THIS WAS THE CASE IN NINETEENTH-CENTURY AMERICA. BRITAIN, HOWEVER, HAD NO PROBLEM HIRING HUMAN HANDS."

★★★★ Two conclusions worth stating in your own words. First, **mechanisation is not driven by whether a machine exists but by whether labour is scarce** — America mechanised because workers were few; Britain did not because workers were many. ★ **Technology adoption is an economic decision, not a technical inevitability.** Second, and sharper: *"machine-made goods were for export to the colonies."* **The best British output was made by hand for the British rich; the machine output was shipped to India** — where it destroyed the handloom weavers of §3.3. **The colony received precisely what the metropolis did not want.**

## 2.1 The life of the workers

| Element                       | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ★★ How you actually got a job | "As news of possible jobs travelled to the countryside, <b>hundreds tramped to the cities. The actual possibility of getting a job DEPENDED ON EXISTING NETWORKS OF FRIENDSHIP AND KIN RELATIONS.</b> If you had a relative or a friend in a factory, you were <b>more likely to get a job quickly. BUT NOT EVERYONE HAD SOCIAL CONNECTIONS.</b> "*                                                  |
| Where they slept              | "Many job-seekers had to <b>wait weeks, spending nights UNDER BRIDGES or in NIGHT SHELTERS.</b> Some stayed in <b>Night Refuges set up by private individuals</b> ; others went to the <b>CASUAL WARDS maintained by the Poor Law authorities</b> "                                                                                                                                                  |
| ★ The workhouse               | The homeless applied "for tickets to stay overnight in a workhouse", maintained for the "destitute, wayfarers, wanderers and foundling". ⚠️ <b>"Staying in these workhouses was A HUMILIATING EXPERIENCE: everyone was subjected to A MEDICAL EXAMINATION to see whether they were carrying disease, their bodies were cleansed, and their clothes purified. They had to also do HARD LABOUR."</b> * |
| ★★ Seasonality                | "Seasonality of work meant <b>PROLONGED PERIODS WITHOUT WORK.</b> After the busy season was over, the <b>poor were on the streets again.</b> Some returned to the countryside after the winter... But most looked for <b>odd jobs, which till the mid-nineteenth century were difficult to find</b> "                                                                                                |

### ★★★★ On wages — a genuinely subtle passage, and worth reading twice:

\*"Wages increased somewhat in the early nineteenth century. **BUT THEY TELL US LITTLE ABOUT THE WELFARE OF THE WORKERS.**"\*

- \*"The average figures **HIDE THE VARIATIONS** between trades and the **FLUCTUATIONS** from year to year."\*
- ★ "when prices rose sharply during the prolonged **NAPOLEONIC WAR, THE REAL VALUE of what the workers earned FELL SIGNIFICANTLY, since the same wages could now buy fewer things.**"
- ★★ \*"the income of workers **depended NOT ON THE WAGE RATE ALONE.** What was also critical was **THE PERIOD OF EMPLOYMENT: THE NUMBER OF DAYS OF WORK determined the average daily income.**"\*
- ★★ \*"At the best of times till the mid-nineteenth century, **about 10 PER CENT of the urban population were EXTREMELY POOR.** In periods of economic slump, **like the 1830s, the proportion of unemployed went up to anything between 35 AND 75 PER CENT in different regions.**"\*

🎯 ★★★★★ This is a lesson in reading statistics, and it transfers straight to GS3. A rising average wage can coexist with falling welfare, because (i) averages conceal distribution, (ii) money wages are not real wages, and (iii) a daily rate means nothing without the **number of days worked.** ★ A worker paid well for 90 days a year is not well paid. Use this framing whenever you write about employment data.

### The Spinning Jenny — ★★★★★ NCERT asks why women attacked it

Word: ★★ Spinning Jenny — "devised by JAMES HARGREAVES in 1764, this machine **SPEEDED UP THE SPINNING PROCESS AND REDUCED LABOUR DEMAND.** By turning ONE SINGLE WHEEL a worker could set in motion A NUMBER OF SPINDLES and spin SEVERAL THREADS at the same time."



★ ★ ★ \*"**The FEAR OF UNEMPLOYMENT made workers HOSTILE to the introduction of new technology.** When the Spinning Jenny was introduced in the woollen industry, ★ **WOMEN WHO SURVIVED ON HAND SPINNING BEGAN ATTACKING THE NEW MACHINES.** This conflict over the introduction of the jenny continued for a long time."\*

**Source B — a magistrate's report, 1790**, called in to protect a manufacturer's property: *"From the depredations of a lawless Banditti of colliers AND THEIR WIVES, FOR THE WIVES HAD LOST THEIR WORK TO SPINNING ENGINES... they advanced at first with much insolence, avowing their intention of CUTTING TO PIECES THE MACHINE lately introduced in the woollen manufacture; WHICH THEY SUPPOSE, IF GENERALLY ADOPTED, WILL LESSEN THE DEMAND FOR MANUAL LABOUR.* ★ *The WOMEN became CLAMOROUS. The MEN were more open to conviction and after some expostulation were induced to desist."*

🎯 ★ ★ ★ ★ Answer the "why did women attack the Jenny?" question precisely, because the gendered detail is the whole point. Hand spinning was women's work — the family income depended on the wife's spinning while the husband mined or wove. The Jenny let **one worker do the work of many**, so it destroyed **specifically the women's earnings**. ★ That is exactly why the magistrate records that the women were "clamorous" while the men "were more open to conviction": **the men had not lost their jobs**. The machine did not threaten a household equally, and the resistance to it was correspondingly unequal. 🔗 \*(Compare Class 9's supplement: enclosure destroyed the women's and children's contribution first — cow-keeping, gleanings, firewood. **Technological and legal change repeatedly hit women's work before men's.**)\*

**And then the relief after the 1840s:**

\*"**After the 1840s, BUILDING ACTIVITY INTENSIFIED in the cities**, opening up greater opportunities of employment. **Roads were widened, new railway stations came up, railway lines were extended, tunnels dug, drainage and sewers laid, rivers embanked.** ★ **The number of workers employed in the TRANSPORT industry DOUBLED IN THE 1840s, and DOUBLED AGAIN in the subsequent 30 years.**"\*

### 3 Industrialisation in the Colonies

#### 3.1 The age of Indian textiles ★★★★★

##### BEFORE THE MACHINE AGE

"SILK AND COTTON GOODS FROM INDIA DOMINATED THE INTERNATIONAL MARKET IN TEXTILES. COARSER COTTONS were produced in many countries, BUT THE FINER VARIETIES OFTEN CAME FROM INDIA."

##### THE LAND ROUTES

"ARMENIAN AND PERSIAN MERCHANTS took the goods from PUNJAB to AFGHANISTAN, EASTERN PERSIA and CENTRAL ASIA. Bales of fine textiles were carried ON CAMEL BACK via the NORTH-WEST FRONTIER, through MOUNTAIN PASSES and ACROSS DESERTS."

THE SEA ROUTES -- the three pre-colonial ports  
SURAT (Gujarat coast) -> the GULF and RED SEA ports  
MASULIPATAM (Coromandel) -> SOUTHEAST ASIAN ports  
HOOGLY (Bengal) -> SOUTHEAST ASIAN ports

##### THE INDIAN NETWORK BEHIND IT

"A variety of INDIAN MERCHANTS AND BANKERS were involved -- FINANCING PRODUCTION, CARRYING GOODS and SUPPLYING EXPORTERS. SUPPLY MERCHANTS linked the port towns to the inland regions. They GAVE ADVANCES TO WEAVERS, PROCURED the woven cloth from weaving villages, and CARRIED THE SUPPLY TO THE PORTS. At the port, the big shippers and export merchants had BROKERS who NEGOTIATED THE PRICE and bought goods from the supply merchants operating inland."

"BY THE 1750s THIS NETWORK, CONTROLLED BY INDIAN MERCHANTS, WAS BREAKING DOWN."

#### How it broke — ★★★★★ the mechanism:

\*"The European companies gradually gained power — **first securing a variety of CONCESSIONS from local courts, then the MONOPOLY RIGHTS to trade.** This resulted in a **DECLINE OF THE OLD PORTS OF SURAT AND HOOGLY** through which local merchants had operated. **Exports from these ports fell dramatically, THE CREDIT THAT HAD FINANCED THE EARLIER TRADE BEGAN DRYING UP, and THE LOCAL BANKERS SLOWLY WENT BANKRUPT.**"\*

##### ★★★★★ The Surat figures

|                                                                    |                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Gross value of trade through Surat, last years of the 17th century | Rs 16 million           |
| By the 1740s                                                       | slumped to Rs 3 million |

★★★★★ \*"While SURAT and HOOGLY DECAYED, BOMBAY and CALCUTTA GREW. THIS SHIFT FROM THE OLD PORTS TO THE NEW ONES WAS AN INDICATOR OF THE GROWTH OF COLONIAL POWER. Trade through the new ports came to be **controlled by European companies, and was carried in EUROPEAN SHIPS.** While many of the old trading houses collapsed, **those that wanted to survive HAD TO NOW OPERATE WITHIN A NETWORK SHAPED BY EUROPEAN TRADING COMPANIES.**"\*

🎯 ★★★★★ **The port shift is the most elegant single indicator in the chapter, and it makes an excellent short answer.** Surat and Hoogly were **Indian-financed, Indian-brokered, serving Asian markets.** Bombay and Calcutta were **European-controlled, European-shipped, serving European markets.** ★ **The same subcontinent, the same goods, a different set of hands on every stage.** Note the second-order effect too: **the collapse of the ports bankrupted the indigenous banking system**, which is why India entered the industrial age with its own commercial capital destroyed.

### 🌸 3.2 What happened to weavers? — the gomastha ★★★★★

**First, the surprising fact: \*"The consolidation of East India Company power after the 1760s DID NOT INITIALLY LEAD TO A DECLINE IN TEXTILE EXPORTS from India.** British cotton industries had not yet expanded and Indian fine textiles were in great demand in Europe. So the company was **KEEN ON EXPANDING textile exports from India.**"\*

#### THE COMPANY'S PROBLEM BEFORE IT HELD POWER

"Before establishing political power in BENGAL and CARNATIC in the 1760s and 1770s, the Company had found it DIFFICULT TO ENSURE A REGULAR SUPPLY of goods for export."

"The FRENCH, DUTCH, PORTUGUESE as well as LOCAL TRADERS COMPETED in the market to secure woven cloth. SO THE WEAVER AND SUPPLY MERCHANTS COULD BARGAIN AND TRY SELLING THE PRODUCE TO THE BEST BUYER."

"Company officials continuously complained of DIFFICULTIES OF SUPPLY AND THE HIGH PRICES."

|  
"HOWEVER, ONCE THE EAST INDIA COMPANY ESTABLISHED POLITICAL POWER, IT COULD ASSERT A MONOPOLY RIGHT TO TRADE." It developed "a system of management and control that would ELIMINATE COMPETITION, CONTROL COSTS, and ENSURE REGULAR SUPPLIES" -- through TWO steps:

#### STEP ONE -- THE GOMASTHA

"the Company tried to ELIMINATE THE EXISTING TRADERS AND BROKERS connected with the cloth trade, and establish A MORE DIRECT CONTROL OVER THE WEAVER. It appointed A PAID SERVANT CALLED THE GOMASTHA to:

- SUPERVISE WEAVERS
- COLLECT SUPPLIES
- EXAMINE THE QUALITY OF CLOTH"

#### STEP TWO -- THE SYSTEM OF ADVANCES

"it PREVENTED Company weavers from DEALING WITH OTHER BUYERS. Once an order was placed, THE WEAVERS WERE GIVEN LOANS to purchase the raw material. THOSE WHO TOOK LOANS HAD TO HAND OVER THE CLOTH THEY PRODUCED TO THE GOMASTHA. THEY COULD NOT TAKE IT TO ANY OTHER TRADER."

### ★★★★★ What the advances did to the weaver's household:

\*"As loans flowed in and the demand for fine textiles expanded, **weavers EAGERLY took the advances, hoping to earn more.** Many weavers had **small plots of land which they had earlier cultivated along with weaving**, and the produce from this **took care of their family needs.** ★★ **NOW THEY HAD TO LEASE OUT THE LAND AND DEVOTE ALL THEIR TIME TO WEAVING.** Weaving, in fact, **required the labour of THE ENTIRE FAMILY, with children and women all engaged in different stages.**"\*

🎯 ★★★★★ **That is the trap, and it is worth spelling out.** The weaver who also farmed had **two legs to stand on** — if cloth prices fell, the family still ate. Taking the advance meant **leasing out the land**, which converted a semi-independent household into one **wholly dependent on a single buyer at a price that buyer set**. ★ **Specialisation increased output and destroyed security** — the same trade-off as the Irish potato in Ch.3.

And the gomastha as a person — ★★★★★ note the contrast NCERT draws:

| The old supply merchant                                                                                                                                                      | The new gomastha                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "very often <b>LIVED WITHIN THE WEAVING VILLAGES</b> , and had <b>a CLOSE RELATIONSHIP with the weavers, LOOKING AFTER THEIR NEEDS and HELPING THEM IN TIMES OF CRISIS</b> " | ★★★ <b>"OUTSIDERS, with NO LONG-TERM SOCIAL LINK with the village. They acted ARROGANTLY, MARCHED INTO VILLAGES WITH SEPOYS AND PEONS, and PUNISHED WEAVERS FOR DELAYS IN SUPPLY — often BEATING AND FLOGGING them"</b> |

Word: ★ Sepoy — "this is how the British pronounced the word *sipahi*, meaning an Indian soldier in the service of the British."

★★★★★ **\*"The weavers LOST THE SPACE TO BARGAIN for prices and sell to different buyers: the price they received from the Company was MISERABLY LOW and THE LOANS THEY HAD ACCEPTED TIED THEM TO THE COMPANY."**\*

★★★★★ How weavers resisted — three ways:

1. "In many places in **CARNATIC and BENGAL**, weavers **DESERTED VILLAGES AND MIGRATED, setting up looms in other villages where they had some family relation**"
2. "Elsewhere, **weavers ALONG WITH THE VILLAGE TRADERS REVOLTED, opposing the Company and its officials**"
3. ★ "Over time **many weavers began REFUSING LOANS, CLOSING DOWN THEIR WORKSHOPS and TAKING TO AGRICULTURAL LABOUR**"

🔗 ★★★★★ The gomastha system is **EXACTLY** the opium and indigo system you met in the Class 9 supplement and Class 8 Ch.3: **an advance that buys the producer's future decisions**, a company servant enforcing it, a price set by the buyer, and no legal exit. ★ **Opium, indigo and cotton cloth — three commodities, one machine.** If you understand one you can answer on any of them, and citing the parallel makes the answer far stronger.

### 🚩 3.3 Manchester comes to India — ★★★★★ the THREE blows

**The prediction that failed:** **\*"In 1772, HENRY PATULLO**, a Company official, had ventured to say that the demand for Indian textiles **COULD NEVER REDUCE, since no other nation produced goods of the same quality.**"\*

| ★★★★★ The collapse of piece-goods in India's exports |                                |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 1811–12                                              | 33 per cent of India's exports |
| 1850–51                                              | ★ no more than 3 per cent      |

BLOW ONE -- THE EXPORT MARKET CLOSED (tariffs)

"As cotton industries developed in England, INDUSTRIAL GROUPS began worrying about imports. They PRESSURISED THE GOVERNMENT TO IMPOSE IMPORT DUTIES ON COTTON TEXTILES so that MANCHESTER GOODS COULD SELL IN BRITAIN WITHOUT FACING ANY COMPETITION FROM OUTSIDE."

BLOW TWO -- THE HOME MARKET WAS FLOODED

"At the same time INDUSTRIALISTS PERSUADED THE EAST INDIA COMPANY TO SELL BRITISH MANUFACTURES IN INDIAN MARKETS."

COTTON PIECE-GOODS AS A SHARE OF INDIAN IMPORTS:

end of the 18th century ... VIRTUALLY NONE

by 1850 ..... OVER 31 PER CENT

by the 1870s ..... OVER 50 PER CENT

"Produced by machines at LOWER COSTS, the imported cotton goods were SO CHEAP that weavers COULD NOT EASILY COMPETE."

"COTTON WEAVERS IN INDIA THUS FACED TWO PROBLEMS AT THE SAME TIME: THEIR EXPORT MARKET COLLAPSED, AND THE LOCAL MARKET SHRANK, BEING GLUTTED WITH MANCHESTER IMPORTS."  
"By the 1850s, reports from most weaving regions of India narrated stories of DECLINE AND DESOLATION."

BLOW THREE -- THE RAW MATERIAL WAS TAKEN TOO (1860s)

"By the 1860s, weavers faced a NEW problem. They COULD NOT GET SUFFICIENT SUPPLY OF RAW COTTON of good quality."

WHEN THE AMERICAN CIVIL WAR BROKE OUT AND COTTON SUPPLIES FROM THE US WERE CUT OFF, BRITAIN TURNED TO INDIA.

As raw cotton exports from India increased, THE PRICE OF RAW COTTON SHOT UP. WEAVERS IN INDIA WERE STARVED OF SUPPLIES AND FORCED TO BUY RAW COTTON AT EXORBITANT PRICES.  
IN THIS SITUATION WEAVING COULD NOT PAY."

AND A FOURTH, at the century's end:

"FACTORIES IN INDIA BEGAN PRODUCTION, FLOODING THE MARKET WITH MACHINE-GOODS. HOW COULD WEAVING INDUSTRIES POSSIBLY SURVIVE?"

**Source C — the Commissioner of Patna:** *"It appears that **twenty years ago**, a brisk trade was carried on in the manufacture of cloth at JAHANABAD and BEHAR, which has in the former place **ENTIRELY CEASED**, while in the latter the amount of manufacture is **very limited**, in consequence of the **CHEAP AND DURABLE GOODS FROM MANCHESTER** with which the Native manufactures are **UNABLE TO COMPETE**."*

**Source D — the Census Report of Central Provinces, 1872, on the KOSHTIS**, a weaving community: *"The Koshtis, like the weavers of the finer kinds of cloth in other parts of India, **have FALLEN UPON EVIL TIMES**. They are unable to compete with the **SHOWY GOODS** which Manchester sends in such profusion, and they have of late years **EMIGRATED IN GREAT NUMBERS**, chiefly to **BERAR**, where **AS DAY LABOURERS** they are able to obtain wages..."*

🎯 ★★★★★ The three blows in sequence are the answer to any de-industrialisation question, and the third is the one candidates forget. Tariffs shut the **export** market; cheap imports took the **home** market; and then the American Civil War made even the **raw material** unaffordable. ★ A weaver could survive losing one market. Losing the export market, the home market and the cotton supply within sixty years left nothing. And note the human ending in Source D — **skilled weavers of fine cloth migrating to become day labourers**. That is de-industrialisation as it was actually lived: **not unemployment but DE-SKILLING**.

## 4 Factories Come Up

### The first mills — ★★ a standard Prelims list

| Year    | Mill                                                                                                       |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ★ 1854  | The <b>first cotton mill in BOMBAY</b> ( <i>went into production two years later</i> )                     |
| ★ 1855  | The <b>first JUTE mill in BENGAL</b> ( <i>another in 1862</i> )                                            |
| 1862    | <b>Four cotton mills at work</b> with <b>94,000 spindles</b> and <b>2,150 looms</b>                        |
| ★ 1860s | The <b>ELGIN MILL</b> started in <b>KANPUR</b> ; "a year later the <b>first cotton mill of AHMEDABAD</b> " |
| ★ 1874  | "the <b>first spinning and weaving mill of MADRAS</b> began production"                                    |
| ★★ 1912 | " <b>J.N. Tata set up the first IRON AND STEEL WORKS in India at JAMSHEDPUR</b> "                          |

⚠ ★★ The caption that matters: \*"**Iron and steel industries in India started MUCH LATER than textiles. In colonial India INDUSTRIAL MACHINERY, RAILWAYS AND LOCOMOTIVES WERE MOSTLY IMPORTED. SO CAPITAL GOODS INDUSTRIES COULD NOT REALLY DEVELOP IN ANY SIGNIFICANT WAY TILL INDEPENDENCE.**"\* 🎯 This is the deepest structural point about colonial industrialisation and it is easy to miss. India could build **consumer-goods industries** (cloth, jute) but not the industries **that build machines**. ★ A country that cannot make its own machines cannot industrialise on its own terms — and this is precisely why independent India's Second Five Year Plan put heavy industry first.

### 4.1 The early entrepreneurs — ★★ where the capital came from

★★★ The uncomfortable origin: \*"**The history of many business groups goes back to TRADE WITH CHINA. From the late eighteenth century... the British in India began EXPORTING OPIUM TO CHINA and took TEA from China to England. MANY INDIANS BECAME JUNIOR PLAYERS IN THIS TRADE, providing FINANCE, procuring SUPPLIES, and SHIPPING CONSIGNMENTS. Having earned through trade, some of these businessmen had visions of developing INDUSTRIAL ENTERPRISES in India.**"\*



| Entrepreneur                                                     | Detail                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ★★ Dwarkanath Tagore (Bengal)                                    | "made his fortune in the <b>China trade</b> before he turned to industrial investment, <b>setting up SIX JOINT-STOCK COMPANIES in the 1830s and 1840s</b> " — "Tagore's enterprises <b>sank along with those of others in the wider business crises of the 1840s</b> ". He "believed India would develop through <b>westernisation and industrialisation</b> " and invested in <b>shipping, shipbuilding, mining, banking, plantations and insurance</b> |
| ★★ Dinshaw Petit and Jamsetjee Nusserwanjee Tata (Bombay Parsis) | "who built <b>huge industrial empires</b> in India, accumulated their initial wealth <b>partly from exports to CHINA, and partly from RAW COTTON SHIPMENTS to England</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| ★★ Seth Hukumchand                                               | "a <b>MARWARI</b> businessman who set up the <b>first Indian JUTE MILL in CALCUTTA in 1917</b> , also <b>traded with China</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| ★ G.D. Birla                                                     | "So did <b>the father as well as grandfather</b> of the famous industrialist"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| ★ Jamsetjee Jeejeebhoy                                           | "the <b>son of a Parsi weaver...</b> involved in the <b>China trade and shipping</b> . He owned <b>a large fleet of ships, but COMPETITION FROM ENGLISH AND AMERICAN SHIPPERS FORCED HIM TO SELL HIS SHIPS by the 1850s</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Other networks                                                   | "Some merchants from <b>MADRAS traded with BURMA</b> while others had links with the <b>MIDDLE EAST and EAST AFRICA</b> "; and other groups <b>operated within India</b> — "carrying goods from one place to another, banking money, transferring funds between cities, and financing traders"                                                                                                                                                           |

★★★★ State the irony plainly, because it is genuinely important and NCERT does not soften it: a substantial part of the capital that built Indian industry — and later funded the national movement — was accumulated in the **OPIUM TRADE**. (Class 9 supplement §3 is the full story of what that trade did to China and to Bengal's peasants.) **The Tatas, the Birlas and the Congress's later financiers stand at the end of that chain.** An answer that notices this is more honest than one that treats Indian enterprise as simply heroic.

★★★ And how colonial control squeezed them:

\*"As colonial control over Indian trade tightened, **the space within which Indian merchants could function became INCREASINGLY LIMITED**. They were **BARRED FROM TRADING WITH EUROPE IN MANUFACTURED GOODS**, and had to **EXPORT MOSTLY RAW MATERIALS AND FOOD GRAINS — RAW COTTON, OPIUM, WHEAT AND INDIGO — required by the British**. They were also **GRADUALLY EDGED OUT OF THE SHIPPING BUSINESS**."\*

| ★★★★ The European Managing Agencies |                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Their dominance                     | " <b>Till the First World War, European Managing Agencies in fact CONTROLLED A LARGE SECTOR OF INDIAN INDUSTRIES</b> "                    |
| ★ The big three                     | <b>Bird Heiglers &amp; Co., Andrew Yule, and Jardine Skinner &amp; Co.</b>                                                                |
| What they did                       | " <b>mobilised capital, set up joint-stock companies and managed them</b> "                                                               |
| ★★★★ The division of labour         | "In most instances <b>INDIAN FINANCIERS PROVIDED THE CAPITAL while THE EUROPEAN AGENCIES MADE ALL INVESTMENT AND BUSINESS DECISIONS</b> " |
| ★★ And the exclusion                | "The European merchant-industrialists had <b>their own CHAMBERS OF COMMERCE which INDIAN BUSINESSMEN WERE NOT ALLOWED TO JOIN</b> "       |

🔗 ★★★★★ "Indians provided the capital; Europeans made the decisions" — and Indians could not even join the chamber of commerce. ★ This is precisely why the business classes backed the national movement (Ch.2 §3.2) and why they formed FICCI in 1927: they were not excluded from the economy but from control of it. Economic nationalism among Indian industrialists was a demand for decision-making, not merely for profit.

## 👤 4.2 Where did the workers come from?

| ★★★★ The numbers                  |                |
|-----------------------------------|----------------|
| Workers in Indian factories, 1901 | 584,000        |
| By 1946                           | over 2,436,000 |

- ★ **Mostly local:** *"In most industrial regions workers came from **the districts around**. Peasants and artisans who found no work in the village went to the industrial centres."* **Over 50% of workers in the Bombay cotton industries in 1911 came from the neighbouring district of RATNAGIRI**, while the mills of Kanpur got most of their textile hands from within the district of Kanpur.
- ★★ **And they went back:** *"Most often millworkers **MOVED BETWEEN THE VILLAGE AND THE CITY, RETURNING TO THEIR VILLAGE HOMES DURING HARVESTS AND FESTIVALS.**"*\*
- ★ **Later, further:** *"From the **United Provinces** they went to work in the **textile mills of Bombay** and in the **jute mills of Calcutta.**"*

## ★★★★ The jobber — a figure worth knowing well:

\*"Getting jobs was **always difficult**, even when mills multiplied... **The numbers seeking work were ALWAYS MORE THAN THE JOBS AVAILABLE.** Entry into the mills was also restricted. Industrialists usually employed a **JOBBER** to get new recruits. ★ **Very often the jobber was AN OLD AND TRUSTED WORKER.** He got people from **HIS VILLAGE**, ensured them jobs, helped them **SETTLE IN THE CITY** and provided them **MONEY IN TIMES OF CRISIS.** The jobber therefore became **A PERSON WITH SOME AUTHORITY AND POWER.** ⚠️ He began **DEMANDING MONEY AND GIFTS FOR HIS FAVOUR** and **CONTROLLING THE LIVES OF WORKERS.**"\*

**Source E — Vasant Parkar, once a Bombay millworker:** *"The workers would **PAY THE JOBBERS MONEY** to get their sons work in the mill... The mill worker was **closely associated with his village, PHYSICALLY AND EMOTIONALLY.** He would go home to cut the harvest and for sowing. ★ **The KONKANI** would go home to cut the **PADDY** and the **GHATI**, the **SUGARCANE.** It was **AN ACCEPTED PRACTICE** for which **THE MILLS GRANTED LEAVE.**"*\* **Source F — Bhai Bhosle, trade unionist, on the 1930s–40s:** *"In those days, **the shift was 10 HOURS — from 5 pm to 3 am — TERRIBLE WORKING HOURS.** My father worked for **35 YEARS;** he got the **ASTHMA LIKE DISEASE** and could not work any more... Then my father **WENT BACK TO VILLAGE.**"*\*

🎯 ★★★★★ **The jobber shows how a kindness becomes a racket, and the mechanism is worth stating.** He begins as **the trusted man from your own village** who finds you work, houses you and lends you money — genuinely useful in a city where jobs are rationed by connection. But **because entry is scarce and he controls it**, that same position converts into **the power to extract money and gifts and to control workers' lives**. ★ **Where jobs are fewer than seekers, whoever allocates them acquires power over the whole of a worker's existence.** *(This is the same structure as the mahato with opium advances and the gomastha with cloth — the intermediary who is both patron and predator.)* ⚠️ **And note Bhosle's last line: a 35-year career ending in disease and a return to the village.** The city took his working life and sent back the illness. **Industrial labour in colonial India was largely circular migration, and the village absorbed the costs the mill would not.**

## 5 The Peculiarities of Industrial Growth ★★★★★

### 🎯 What each side chose to make

#### THE EUROPEAN MANAGING AGENCIES

"were interested in CERTAIN KINDS OF PRODUCTS. They established TEA AND COFFEE PLANTATIONS, ACQUIRING LAND AT CHEAP RATES FROM THE COLONIAL GOVERNMENT; and they invested in MINING, INDIGO and JUTE.

MOST OF THESE WERE PRODUCTS REQUIRED PRIMARILY FOR EXPORT TRADE AND NOT FOR SALE IN INDIA."

#### THE INDIAN INDUSTRIALISTS -- and why they made YARN

"When Indian businessmen began setting up industries in the late nineteenth century, THEY AVOIDED COMPETING WITH MANCHESTER GOODS IN THE INDIAN MARKET.

SINCE YARN WAS NOT AN IMPORTANT PART OF BRITISH IMPORTS INTO INDIA, THE EARLY COTTON MILLS IN INDIA PRODUCED COARSE COTTON YARN (THREAD) RATHER THAN FABRIC.

When yarn was imported it was ONLY OF THE SUPERIOR VARIETY.

The yarn produced in Indian spinning mills was USED BY HANDLOOM WEAVERS IN INDIA or EXPORTED TO CHINA."

🎯 ★★★★★ **This is one of the sharpest observations in the book.** Indian industrialists did not choose yarn because yarn was easy — **they chose the one product the British were not selling here**, because competing head-on with Manchester was impossible. ★ **Colonial industry grew in the gaps left by the metropolitan economy**, which is a precise and quotable description of dependent industrialisation. **And note the beautiful complementarity: Indian mill yarn fed Indian handloom weavers** — the two "rival" sectors were actually supplying each other.

## The shift from yarn to cloth

BY THE FIRST DECADE OF THE TWENTIETH CENTURY, two changes:

### 1. THE SWADESHI MOVEMENT

"As the swadeshi movement gathered momentum, NATIONALISTS MOBILISED PEOPLE TO BOYCOTT FOREIGN CLOTH. INDUSTRIAL GROUPS ORGANISED THEMSELVES TO PROTECT THEIR COLLECTIVE INTERESTS, PRESSURISING THE GOVERNMENT TO INCREASE TARIFF PROTECTION AND GRANT OTHER CONCESSIONS."

### 2. THE CHINA MARKET CLOSED

"FROM 1906 the EXPORT OF INDIAN YARN TO CHINA DECLINED since produce from CHINESE AND JAPANESE MILLS FLOODED THE CHINESE MARKET."

|  
"So industrialists in India began SHIFTING FROM YARN TO CLOTH PRODUCTION. COTTON PIECE-GOODS PRODUCTION IN INDIA DOUBLED BETWEEN 1900 AND 1912."

## ★ The First World War — ★★★★★ NCERT asks this directly

"Yet, TILL the First World War, INDUSTRIAL GROWTH WAS SLOW. THE WAR CREATED A DRAMATICALLY NEW SITUATION."

### 1. THE COMPETITION VANISHED

"With BRITISH MILLS BUSY WITH WAR PRODUCTION to meet the needs of the army, MANCHESTER IMPORTS INTO INDIA DECLINED. Suddenly, INDIAN MILLS HAD A VAST HOME MARKET TO SUPPLY."

### 2. THE ARMY BECAME A CUSTOMER

"As the war prolonged, Indian factories were called upon to supply WAR NEEDS: JUTE BAGS, CLOTH FOR ARMY UNIFORMS, TENTS AND LEATHER BOOTS, HORSE AND MULE SADDLES and a host of other items."

### 3. THE RESPONSE

"NEW FACTORIES WERE SET UP and OLD ONES RAN MULTIPLE SHIFTS. MANY NEW WORKERS WERE EMPLOYED and EVERYONE WAS MADE TO WORK LONGER HOURS. Over the war years INDUSTRIAL PRODUCTION BOOMED."

|  
AND AFTER THE WAR -- THE PERMANENT SHIFT  
"MANCHESTER COULD NEVER RECAPTURE ITS OLD POSITION IN THE INDIAN MARKET. Unable to modernise and compete with the US, GERMANY and JAPAN, the economy of Britain CRUMBLED after the war. COTTON PRODUCTION COLLAPSED and exports of cotton cloth from Britain FELL DRAMATICALLY.

WITHIN THE COLONIES, LOCAL INDUSTRIALISTS GRADUALLY CONSOLIDATED THEIR POSITION, SUBSTITUTING FOREIGN MANUFACTURES AND CAPTURING THE HOME MARKET."

 ★★★★★ This dovetails exactly with Ch.3 §3.2 — "while Britain was preoccupied with war, industries had developed in India and Japan... Britain found it difficult to recapture its earlier position of dominance in the Indian market." **Same fact, two chapters, told from the British and the Indian side.** Use both.

## 🌐 5.1 Small-scale industries predominate — ★★★★★ the chapter's punchline

| Fact                                                    | Figure                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ★★ Where large industries were, 1911                    | "about <b>67 PER CENT</b> were located in <b>BENGAL and BOMBAY</b> "                                              |
| ★★★★ Share of industrial labour in REGISTERED FACTORIES | ★ <b>5 PER CENT</b> in 1911 and <b>10 PER CENT</b> in 1931                                                        |
| ★★ Where the rest worked                                | "in <b>small workshops and household units, often located in ALLEYS AND BYLANES, INVISIBLE TO THE PASSER-BY</b> " |
| ★★★★ Handloom cloth production, 1900 → 1940             | "expanded steadily: <b>ALMOST TREBLING</b> "                                                                      |

★★★★★ Stop on that last row. Between 1900 and 1940 — the height of the factory age — Indian **HANDLOOM** output nearly **TREBLED**. \*"**While cheap machine-made thread WIPED OUT THE SPINNING INDUSTRY in the nineteenth century, THE WEAVERS SURVIVED, despite problems.**"\* Spinning died; weaving did not.

★★★★★ How did the weavers survive? — **THREE** reasons, and NCERT asks for them:

REASON 1 -- TECHNOLOGICAL ADAPTATION (the fly shuttle)  
 "HANDICRAFTS PEOPLE ADOPT NEW TECHNOLOGY IF THAT HELPS THEM IMPROVE PRODUCTION WITHOUT EXCESSIVELY PUSHING UP COSTS."  
 "By the second decade of the twentieth century we find weavers using LOOMS WITH A FLY SHUTTLE. This INCREASED PRODUCTIVITY PER WORKER, SPEEDED UP PRODUCTION and REDUCED LABOUR DEMAND."  
 "By 1941, OVER 35 PER CENT of handlooms in India were fitted with fly shuttles: in regions like TRAVANCORE, MADRAS, MYSORE, COCHIN, BENGAL the proportion was 70 TO 80 PER CENT."

REASON 2 -- THE FINER CLOTH HAD A STABLER MARKET  
 "the COARSER cloth was bought by THE POOR and its DEMAND FLUCTUATED VIOLENTLY. In times of BAD HARVESTS AND FAMINES, when the rural poor had little to eat, THEY COULD NOT POSSIBLY BUY CLOTH.  
 The demand for THE FINER VARIETIES bought by the WELL-TO-DO was MORE STABLE. THE RICH COULD BUY THESE EVEN WHEN THE POOR STARVED.  
 FAMINES DID NOT AFFECT THE SALE OF BANARASI OR BALUCHARI SARIS."

REASON 3 -- MILLS COULD NOT COPY SPECIALISED WEAVES  
 "MILLS COULD NOT IMITATE SPECIALISED WEAVES. SARIS WITH WOVEN BORDERS, or the famous LUNGIS AND HANDKERCHIEFS OF MADRAS, COULD NOT BE EASILY DISPLACED BY MILL PRODUCTION."

**Word: ★ Fly shuttle** — "a mechanical device used for weaving, moved by means of ROPES AND PULLIES. It places the HORIZONTAL threads (called the WEFT) into the VERTICAL threads (called the WARP). The invention of the fly shuttle made it possible for weavers to OPERATE LARGE LOOMS AND WEAVE WIDE PIECES OF CLOTH."

⚠️ ★★★★★ But NCERT refuses a happy ending, and you should reproduce its exact balance: \*"**Weavers and other craftspeople who continued to expand production through the twentieth century, DID NOT NECESSARILY PROSPER. THEY LIVED HARD LIVES AND WORKED LONG HOURS. Very often THE ENTIRE HOUSEHOLD — INCLUDING ALL THE WOMEN AND CHILDREN — HAD TO WORK at various stages of the production process. ★★ BUT THEY WERE NOT SIMPLY REMNANTS OF PAST TIMES IN THE AGE OF FACTORIES. THEIR LIFE AND LABOUR WAS INTEGRAL TO THE PROCESS OF INDUSTRIALISATION.**"\*

🎯 ★★★★★ That final sentence is the thesis of the chapter and the best line you can carry into a GS3 answer on the informal sector or MSMEs. Survival was purchased by **self-exploitation** — longer hours and unpaid family labour, including children. **The handloom sector was not a leftover awaiting extinction; it was part of how industrialisation actually worked** — and the same is true of India's informal economy today.

## 6 Market for Goods — advertising ★★ ★

**The problem:** \*"**when new products are produced people have to be PERSUADED to buy them. They have to FEEL LIKE USING the product.**"\* **The answer:** \*"**ADVERTISEMENTS make products appear DESIRABLE AND NECESSARY. They try to SHAPE THE MINDS of people and CREATE NEW NEEDS.... from the very beginning of the industrial age, advertisements have played a part in EXPANDING THE MARKETS for products, and in SHAPING A NEW CONSUMER CULTURE.**"\*

| Device                             | How it worked                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ★★★ The label                      | "When Manchester industrialists began selling cloth in India, they <b>put LABELS on the cloth bundles</b> . The label was needed to make <b>the PLACE OF MANUFACTURE and the NAME OF THE COMPANY familiar</b> to the buyer. The label was also <b>a MARK OF QUALITY</b> . When buyers saw ★★ <b>'MADE IN MANCHESTER' written in bold</b> , they were expected to <b>feel confident</b> about buying the cloth"                         |
| ★★★★ Indian gods on British labels | " <b>Images of INDIAN GODS AND GODDESSES regularly appeared on these labels</b> — Kartika, Lakshmi, Saraswati. ★★ <b>It was as if THE ASSOCIATION WITH GODS GAVE DIVINE APPROVAL to the goods being sold. The imprinted image of Krishna or Saraswati was also intended to MAKE THE MANUFACTURE FROM A FOREIGN LAND APPEAR SOMEWHAT FAMILIAR to Indian people</b> "                                                                    |
| ★★★★ Calendars                     | "By the late nineteenth century, manufacturers were <b>printing CALENDARS</b> to popularise their products. ★★ <b>Unlike newspapers and magazines, CALENDARS WERE USED EVEN BY PEOPLE WHO COULD NOT READ</b> . They were hung <b>in tea shops and in poor people's homes just as much as in offices and middle-class apartments. And those who hung the calendars HAD TO SEE THE ADVERTISEMENTS, DAY AFTER DAY, THROUGH THE YEAR</b> " |
| ★★★ Royal figures                  | " <b>figures of important personages, of EMPERORS AND NAWABS, adorned advertisements... The message very often seemed to say: IF YOU RESPECT THE ROYAL FIGURE, THEN RESPECT THIS PRODUCT; when the product was being used by kings... ITS QUALITY COULD NOT BE QUESTIONED</b> " — e.g. Maharaja Ranjit Singh on a Manchester label                                                                                                     |
| ★★★★ And the Indian counter-move   | *" <b>When INDIAN manufacturers advertised, THE NATIONALIST MESSAGE WAS CLEAR AND LOUD. IF YOU CARE FOR THE NATION THEN BUY PRODUCTS THAT INDIANS PRODUCE. ADVERTISEMENTS BECAME A VEHICLE OF THE NATIONALIST MESSAGE OF SWADESHI.</b> "* — one Indian mill label shows <b>the goddess offering cloth produced in an Ahmedabad mill, and asking people to use things made in India</b>                                                 |



🎯 ★ ★ ★ ★ ★ **The calendar is the cleverest instrument here and worth a sentence of its own.** A newspaper reaches the literate once; **a calendar hangs on a poor household's wall and advertises for 365 days to people who cannot read a word.** ★ **Advertising solved the literacy problem by going visual** — exactly as nationalist **Bharat Mata prints** did (Ch.2 §4) and European **allegories** did (Ch.1 §5). **The same technique carried Manchester cloth and Indian nationalism.** ⚠️ **And note the sequence with real care:** the British used **Indian gods to sell foreign cloth**; Indians then used **the same gods to sell swadeshi cloth.** **The weapon was picked up and turned around** — which is the whole story of Indian nationalism in miniature.

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● Prelims traps

| Trap                                                                              | The truth                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Industrialisation began with factories"                                          | ★★★ <b>Proto-industrialisation</b> — large-scale production for an <b>international market</b> , <b>not based on factories</b> , in the <b>17th and 18th centuries</b>                                                                                           |
| "Guilds encouraged new merchants"                                                 | ★★ Guilds <b>restricted entry</b> , controlled production and prices, and held <b>monopoly rights granted by rulers</b> — which is <b>why merchants went to the countryside</b>                                                                                  |
| "A fuller sorts wool"                                                             | ★ <b>Stapler</b> sorts wool by fibre; <b>fuller</b> gathers cloth by pleating; <b>carding</b> prepares fibres before spinning                                                                                                                                    |
| "Factories appeared in England in the 1780s"                                      | ★ <b>The earliest by the 1730s</b> ; numbers multiplied <b>only in the late eighteenth century</b>                                                                                                                                                               |
| "Britain's raw cotton imports rose from 2.5m to 22m pounds between 1760 and 1850" | ★★ <b>1760 → 1787</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| "Arkwright invented the spinning jenny"                                           | ★★ <b>Arkwright created the COTTON MILL</b> ; the <b>Spinning Jenny</b> was <b>JAMES HARGREAVES, 1764</b> ; the <b>steam engine</b> was <b>Newcomen</b> , improved and patented by <b>JAMES WATT in 1781</b> , manufactured by <b>Mathew Boulton</b>             |
| "By 1800 England had thousands of steam engines"                                  | ★★★ <b>No more than 321</b> — <b>80</b> in cotton, <b>9</b> in wool, the rest in mining, canal works and iron works                                                                                                                                              |
| "By 1900, 80% of Europe's workforce was in advanced industry"                     | ★★★ <b>FALSE</b> — " <b>less than 20 per cent</b> " at the end of the nineteenth century                                                                                                                                                                         |
| "Cotton led British industrialisation throughout"                                 | ★★ <b>Cotton led to the 1840s; then IRON AND STEEL</b> . By <b>1873</b> Britain exported iron and steel worth <b>£77 million</b> — <b>double its cotton export</b>                                                                                               |
| "Industrialists always preferred machines"                                        | ★★★ Four reasons for hand labour: <b>abundant cheap labour</b> , <b>seasonal demand</b> , <b>demand for varied goods (500 hammers, 45 axes)</b> , and <b>upper-class preference for handmade</b> — " <b>machine-made goods were for export to the colonies</b> " |
| "Unemployment in the 1830s slumps was about 10%"                                  | ★★ <b>10% of the urban population were extremely poor at the BEST of times</b> ; in slumps unemployment ran <b>35–75%</b> by region                                                                                                                              |
| "Men led the attacks on the Spinning Jenny"                                       | ★★★ <b>WOMEN</b> , who survived on hand spinning — the 1790 report notes " <b>the wives had lost their work to spinning engines</b> ", <b>the women were "clamorous"</b> while the men <b>"were more open to conviction"</b>                                     |
| "India exported only coarse cotton before the machine age"                        | ★★ " <b>Coarser cottons were produced in many countries, but the FINER varieties often came from India</b> "                                                                                                                                                     |
| "Surat's trade rose in the eighteenth century"                                    | ★★ <b>Rs 16 million</b> in the late 17th century, <b>slumped to Rs 3 million by the 1740s</b> ; <b>Surat and Hoogly decayed while Bombay and Calcutta grew</b>                                                                                                   |
| "The gomastha was an Indian supply merchant"                                      | ★★★ <b>A PAID SERVANT of the Company</b> — an <b>outsider</b> with no village link, who <b>marched in with sepoys and peons</b> and <b>flogged weavers for delays</b>                                                                                            |
| "Indian piece-goods exports were 3% in 1811-12"                                   | ★★ <b>33% in 1811-12 → no more than 3% by 1850-51</b> . Cotton piece-goods as a share of Indian imports: <b>virtually nil → over 31% by 1850 → over 50% by the 1870s</b>                                                                                         |
| "The American Civil War increased India's cotton exports and helped weavers"      | ★★★ It <b>raised raw cotton exports and the price</b> , so <b>Indian weavers were starved of supplies and forced to buy at exorbitant prices</b>                                                                                                                 |
| "The first Indian jute mill was set up by Tata"                                   | ★★ <b>Seth Hukumchand, Calcutta, 1917</b> (the first jute mill in Bengal overall was <b>1855</b> , under European ownership). <b>J.N. Tata set up the first iron and steel works at Jamshedpur in 1912</b>                                                       |

| Trap                                                          | The truth                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Indian mills first produced fine cloth"                      | ★ ★ ★ <b>COARSE COTTON YARN</b> , because <b>yarn was not an important part of British imports</b> ; the yarn fed <b>Indian handloom weavers</b> or went to <b>China</b>                                                                                        |
| "Indian yarn exports to China rose after 1906"                | ★ ★ <b>Declined</b> , as <b>Chinese and Japanese mill produce flooded that market</b> — which is why Indian mills shifted to cloth; <b>piece-goods production doubled 1900–1912</b>                                                                             |
| "Most Indian industrial workers were in registered factories" | ★ ★ ★ <b>5% in 1911, 10% in 1931</b> ; the rest in <b>small workshops and household units</b>                                                                                                                                                                   |
| "Handloom production collapsed in the twentieth century"      | ★ ★ ★ ★ It almost <b>TREBLED between 1900 and 1940</b> ; <b>over 35% of handlooms had fly shuttles by 1941</b> (70–80% in Travancore, Madras, Mysore, Cochin, Bengal)                                                                                           |
| "European Managing Agencies provided the capital"             | ★ ★ ★ <b>"Indian financiers provided the capital while the European Agencies made all investment and business decisions"</b> — and Indians <b>could not join their chambers of commerce</b> . The big three: <b>Bird Heiglers, Andrew Yule, Jardine Skinner</b> |

## ● Mains angles

- ★ ★ ★ ★ "Explain what is meant by proto-industrialisation." — Large-scale production for an international market **before factories**; merchants blocked by **guild monopolies** in towns; peasants pushed by **enclosure** and tiny plots; the **wool-stapler-to-London chain**; **20–25 workers per stage, hundreds per clothier**; control with the merchant, production in the cottage.
- ★ ★ ★ ★ "Why did some industrialists in nineteenth-century Europe prefer hand labour over machines?" (NCERT's own — give all four reasons, and contrast with labour-scarce America.)
- ★ ★ ★ ★ "How did the East India Company procure regular supplies of cotton and silk textiles from Indian weavers?" (NCERT's own.) — Before political power: **competition among French, Dutch, Portuguese and local traders**, so weavers could **bargain**. After: **monopoly right**, then (i) the **gomastha** eliminating brokers and supervising directly, and (ii) the **system of advances** tying the weaver to one buyer. Then the consequences: **land leased out, whole family drawn in, clashes with arrogant outsider gomasthas, floggings, desertion, revolt, and abandonment of the loom for agricultural labour**.
- ★ ★ ★ ★ "The de-industrialisation of India." — The **three blows** (tariffs closing the export market; cheap Manchester imports taking the home market; the **American Civil War** taking the raw cotton), with the **33% → 3% and nil → 31% → 50%** figures, the **Patna and Koshti** sources, and the port shift from **Surat/Hoogly to Bombay/Calcutta**. ★ Combine with Ch.3's multilateral settlement system for a complete answer.
- ★ ★ ★ ★ "Why did industrial production in India increase during the First World War?" (NCERT's own.) — **Manchester imports fell** as British mills turned to war production, leaving Indians a **vast home market**; **army orders** for jute bags, uniforms, tents, boots, saddles; **new factories, multiple shifts, longer hours**; and afterwards **Manchester never recovered its position** while **local industrialists substituted foreign manufactures**.
- ★ ★ ★ ★ "Small-scale production was integral to industrialisation, not a leftover from the past." — Britain: **less than 20% of the workforce** in advanced industry; only **321 steam engines**; "the typical worker... was not a machine operator." India: **5% and 10%** in registered factories; **handloom output trebling 1900–1940** via the **fly shuttle**, the **stable market for fine cloth**, and **weaves mills could not copy** — but sustained by **long hours and unpaid family labour**. ★ This is the strongest GS3 answer available on the informal sector's historical roots.
- ★ ★ ★ "Write an encyclopaedia article on Britain and the history of cotton." (NCERT's own — 1760 imports, the inventions, Arkwright's mill, cotton leading to the 1840s, the Jenny and women's resistance, then iron and steel overtaking by 1873, and the export of machine-made cloth to the colonies.)

- ★★★★★ **Advertising and the making of consumers.** — Labels, "*MADE IN MANCHESTER*", **Indian gods on foreign cloth**, **calendars for the illiterate**, **royal figures**, and the **nationalist reversal of the same devices** for swadeshi.
- ★★★★★ **Essay/historiography: "What historians choose to notice."** — The chapter's own framing: the **dazzling mills** versus the **bylanes and workshops**; "*Dawn of the Century*" and "*Two Magicians*" as **propaganda for progress** and as a **civilisational claim** about East and West.

### Cross-links to build now

- ★★★★★ **Ch.3 of this book** — the **same export figures**, tariffs, the **multilateral settlement system**, and Britain's post-war decline. **These two chapters are one argument.**
- ★★★★★ **Class 9 supplement** — **enclosure created the proto-industrial workforce**; the **opium trade** supplied the capital of India's first industrialists; the **Silesian weavers** and **Captain Swing** are machine-breaking's European twins.
- ★★★★★ **Ch.2 of this book** — **Swadeshi and tariff protection**; why the **business classes** backed the movement; **FICCI 1927**; boycott raising mill and handloom output.
- ★★★★★ **Class 8 Ch.3** — the **indigo advance system**, identical in structure to the gomastha's.
- ★★★★★ **GS3** — MSMEs, the informal sector, import substitution, and why **capital goods** industries mattered so much to independent India.

## Glossary

| Term                           | Meaning                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Proto</b>                   | Indicating the <b>first or early form</b> of something                                                                                    |
| <b>Proto-industrialisation</b> | Large-scale production for an <b>international market before factories</b> , organised by merchants in the countryside                    |
| <b>Guild</b>                   | Association of producers that <b>trained craftspeople, controlled production, regulated prices and restricted entry</b>                   |
| <b>Stapler</b>                 | One who <b>sorts wool</b> according to its fibre                                                                                          |
| <b>Fuller</b>                  | One who " <b>fulls</b> " — <b>gathers cloth by pleating</b>                                                                               |
| <b>Carding</b>                 | Preparing fibres <b>before spinning</b>                                                                                                   |
| <b>Spinning Jenny</b>          | <b>Hargreaves, 1764</b> — one wheel turning many spindles; <b>reduced labour demand</b>                                                   |
| <b>Fly shuttle</b>             | Loom device worked by <b>ropes and pulleys</b> , placing the <b>weft</b> into the <b>warp</b> ; allowed <b>wide cloth and large looms</b> |
| <b>Orient</b>                  | Countries east of the Mediterranean — a term arising from a <b>western viewpoint</b> that sees the region as pre-modern                   |
| <b>Gomastha</b>                | A <b>paid servant of the Company</b> appointed to supervise weavers, collect supplies and check quality                                   |
| <b>Sepoy</b>                   | The British pronunciation of <b>sipahi</b> — an Indian soldier in British service                                                         |
| <b>Jobber</b>                  | An <b>old and trusted worker</b> employed to recruit mill hands, who came to <b>demand money and gifts</b>                                |
| <b>Managing Agencies</b>       | European firms ( <b>Bird Heiglers, Andrew Yule, Jardine Skinner</b> ) that <b>controlled Indian industry till the First World War</b>     |
| <b>Piece-goods</b>             | Cloth sold by the piece — <b>33% of India's exports in 1811-12, under 3% by 1850-51</b>                                                   |

## 60-Second Recap

1. ★★ **The chapter attacks its own opening images** — "*Dawn of the Century*" and "*Two Magicians*" — which cast industrialisation as pure progress and **the East as past, the West as modern**.
2. ★★★ **Proto-industrialisation**: large-scale production for an **international market before factories**. Merchants could not expand in towns because **guilds** trained, priced, restricted entry and held **royal monopolies** — so they went to the countryside, where **enclosure had taken the commons** and tiny plots could not employ whole families.
3. ★★ **The chain**: merchant clothier → **wool stapler** → spinners → weavers → **fullers** → **dyers** → **finishing in London**. **20–25 workers per stage; hundreds per clothier**. Control lay with the **merchant**, production in the **cottage**.
4. ★★ **Factories** came by the **1730s** but multiplied only late in the century. Raw cotton imports rose **2.5m lb (1760) → 22m lb (1787)**; **Arkwright created the cotton mill** — whose real advantage was **supervision, quality control and the regulation of labour**.
5. ★★★ **The pace of change, four points**: cotton led to the **1840s**, then **iron and steel (£77m of exports by 1873, double cotton)**; **less than 20% of the workforce** was in advanced industry at the century's end; **small innovations drove non-mechanised sectors**; and technology spread slowly — ★ **only 321 steam engines in all England** at the century's start. "*The typical worker... was not a machine operator but the traditional craftsman.*"
6. ★★★ **Hand labour was preferred** because labour was **abundant and cheap**, demand was **seasonal**, the market wanted **variety (500 hammers, 45 axes)**, and **the upper classes preferred handmade** — "*machine-made goods were for export to the colonies.*" **America, short of labour, mechanised instead.**
7. ★★ **Workers' lives**: jobs got through **kin networks**; nights **under bridges, in night refuges and Casual Wards**; **humiliating workhouses**; **seasonal unemployment**; and wages that "*tell us little about welfare*" because averages hide variation, **real value** fell in the Napoleonic War, and **days of work** mattered as much as the rate — **10% extremely poor at the best of times, 35–75% unemployed in the 1830s slumps**.
8. ★★ **Women attacked the Spinning Jenny** because **hand spinning was their work**; the 1790 report records that **the wives had lost their work** and **the women were "clamorous"** while the men were "*more open to conviction.*" After the **1840s**, building and transport work expanded — **transport employment doubled in the 1840s and doubled again in 30 years**.
9. ★★★ **India before the machine age** dominated the world textile market in **finer varieties**, through **Armenian and Persian** overland routes and the ports of **Surat, Masulipatam and Hoogly**, financed by **Indian merchants and bankers** with **supply merchants and brokers**. ★ **By the 1750s that network was breaking down**: European companies won **concessions then monopoly**, **Surat's trade fell from Rs 16 million to Rs 3 million, credit dried up, local bankers went bankrupt, and Bombay and Calcutta rose** — "*an indicator of the growth of colonial power.*"
10. ★★★ **The gomastha system**: before political power the Company **competed** and complained of high prices; after it, **monopoly**. It **eliminated brokers**, appointed the **gomastha** to supervise, and used **advances** so weavers **could not sell to anyone else**. Weavers **leased out their land**, drew in **women and children**, and faced **outsiders arriving with sepoys and peons who flogged them for delays** — so they **deserted villages, revolted, or abandoned the loom for agricultural labour**.
11. ★★★ **The three blows**: tariffs shut Indian cloth out of Britain; **Manchester imports flooded India (nil → over 31% of imports by 1850 → over 50% by the 1870s)** while piece-goods fell from **33% of exports (1811–12) to under 3% (1850–51)**; and the **American Civil War** sent raw cotton prices up so that **weavers were starved of supplies**. Then **Indian factories** added their own competition.
12. ★★ **The first mills**: **Bombay cotton 1854, Bengal jute 1855, Elgin Mill Kanpur 1860s, Ahmedabad, Madras 1874, and Tata's iron and steel at Jamshedpur, 1912**. ⚠ **Capital goods could**



**not develop till Independence** — machinery, railways and locomotives were **imported**.

13. ★★ ★ **The entrepreneurs' capital came largely from the CHINA (opium) trade** — Dwarkanath Tagore (six joint-stock companies, ruined in the 1840s crisis), Dinshaw Petit, J.N. Tata, Seth Hukumchand (first Indian jute mill, 1917), Birla's father and grandfather. But Indians were **barred from exporting manufactures to Europe, edged out of shipping**, and while **European Managing Agencies (Bird Heiglers, Andrew Yule, Jardine Skinner)** ran industry, ★ *"Indian financiers provided the capital while the European Agencies made all investment and business decisions"* — and **could not join their chambers of commerce**.
14. ★★ **Workers: 584,000 in 1901 → over 2,436,000 by 1946**, mostly from **nearby districts (over 50% of Bombay's cotton workers from Ratnagiri in 1911), returning home for harvests and festivals**. The **jobber** — a trusted village elder who found jobs, housing and loans — became a man who **demanded money and gifts and controlled workers' lives**.
15. ★★ ★ **Peculiarities:** European agencies made **export goods** (tea, coffee, mining, indigo, jute); Indian mills made **coarse YARN**, because **yarn was not an important British import** — feeding **Indian handloom weavers** and **China**. After **1906** the China market closed to Indian yarn, and **Swadeshi** brought boycott and tariff demands, so mills shifted to cloth: **piece-goods production doubled 1900–1912**.
16. ★★ **The First World War transformed everything** — **Manchester imports fell**, Indian mills got a **vast home market** plus **army orders** for jute bags, uniforms, tents, boots and saddles; **new factories, multiple shifts, longer hours**. Afterwards **Manchester never recovered** and **local industrialists captured the home market**.
17. ★★ ★ ★ **And yet small-scale production predominated: 67% of large industry in Bengal and Bombay (1911), but only 5% (1911) and 10% (1931) of industrial labour in registered factories** — the rest **in alleys and bylanes, invisible to the passer-by**. ★ **Handloom cloth output almost trebled between 1900 and 1940**, sustained by the **fly shuttle (over 35% of looms by 1941; 70–80% in Travancore, Madras, Mysore, Cochin and Bengal)**, the **stabler market for fine cloth** (*"famines did not affect the sale of Banarasi or Baluchari saris"*), and **weaves the mills could not imitate**. ⚠ **But survival meant long hours and the labour of the whole household** — *"they were NOT simply remnants of past times... their life and labour was INTEGRAL to the process of industrialisation."*
18. ★★ **Advertising made the consumer: labels** carrying *"MADE IN MANCHESTER"*, **Indian gods** lending divine approval to foreign cloth, **calendars** that advertised year-round **to people who could not read**, and **emperors and nawabs** vouching for quality — until **Indian manufacturers turned the same devices to swadeshi**: *"if you care for the nation then buy products that Indians produce."*

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## **Test Yourself**

### **Prelims style**

1. Proto-industrialisation refers to — **large-scale industrial production for an international market that was NOT based on factories, in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries**.
2. Merchants moved to the countryside because — **urban crafts and trade GUILDS were powerful, restricting entry and holding monopoly rights granted by rulers**.
3. At the beginning of the nineteenth century, the number of steam engines in England was — **no more than 321; of these 80 were in cotton and 9 in wool industries**.
4. True or False: at the end of the nineteenth century, 80% of Europe's workforce was in technologically advanced industry. — **False — less than 20 per cent**.



5. The gomastha was — **a PAID SERVANT of the East India Company**, appointed to supervise weavers, collect supplies and examine quality — an **outsider** who arrived with sepoys and peons.
6. Indian piece-goods as a share of exports fell from — **33% in 1811-12 to no more than 3% by 1850-51**, while cotton piece-goods rose from virtually nothing to **over 50% of Indian imports by the 1870s**.
7. The American Civil War affected Indian weavers by — **raising raw cotton exports and prices, so that weavers were starved of supplies and had to buy at exorbitant prices**.
8. Between 1900 and 1940, Indian handloom cloth production — **almost trebled; by 1941 over 35% of handlooms had fly shuttles**.

### Mains style

9. Explain what is meant by proto-industrialisation. **(150 words)**
10. Why did some industrialists in nineteenth-century Europe prefer hand labour over machines? **(250 words)** ★
11. How did the East India Company procure regular supplies of cotton and silk textiles from Indian weavers? **(250 words)** ★
12. Trace the decline of Indian textiles in the nineteenth century and assess its consequences. **(250 words)** ★
13. Why did industrial production in India increase during the First World War? **(150 words)**
14. "Small-scale production was integral to industrialisation, not a survival from the past." Discuss with reference to Britain and India. **(250 words)** ★ — GS3 crossover
15. Explain why women workers in Britain attacked the Spinning Jenny. **(150 words)**
16. How did advertisements help create markets for new products in colonial India? **(150 words)**

### Self-check (out loud, no notes):

- Define proto-industrialisation and say why merchants left the towns.
- Give the proto-industrial chain in order, with the two odd job-names.
- State what Arkwright's mill actually changed — and note it is not mainly about machines.
- Give the four points on the pace of industrial change, with the steam engine figure.
- Give the four reasons for preferring hand labour, and the American contrast.
- Explain the gomastha system in two steps and its effect on the weaver's household.
- Give the three blows to Indian weavers, in order, with figures.
- Explain why Indian mills first made yarn.
- Give three reasons handloom weaving survived — and the cost of that survival.